

Sam Rivera

Engineering Manager, Billing Platform

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SUMMARY

Founding engineer turned Director of Engineering at Meridian Logistics, where I grew the team from just myself to 20+ engineers spanning backend, frontend, QA, DevOps, and release management, and delivered the infrastructure behind Meridian Logistics becoming the first regulated fintech platform in the US. I architected the backend systems and processes the platform is built on, took releases from ad hoc to a structured bi-weekly cadence across 4 engineering teams, and led the engineering and compliance work across a 7-year regulatory build-out. Hands-on with Node.js and TypeScript, and equally comfortable shaping technical strategy with C-suite leadership, I'm targeting Director of Engineering and VP of Engineering roles where team development and delivery excellence are priorities.

EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Meridian Logistics

Apr 2019 – May 2026

- Built the engineering organization from the ground up, growing from sole backend engineer to a 20+ person team spanning backend, frontend, QA, DevOps, and release management, with full hiring authority and ownership of every career-level and cultural decision.
- Took on scrum and release management across 4 engineering teams, partnering with product and stakeholders to translate business priorities into standardized sprint and epic planning and a bi-weekly release cadence, with delivery spanning regulated milestones including regulatory the platform approval, custody launch, ETH custody, and clearing and settlement approval.
- Coordinated change management and auditor communication across 3 concurrent audits covering backend platform, onboarding, mobile app, and blockchain, managing timelines, drafting responses, conducting the least-privilege access review, and converting audit findings into prioritized remediation items entered into the SDLC workflow.
- Served as engineering lead for incident response across backend, DevOps, and release teams on Meridian Logistics's regulatory-regulated platform, owning technical investigation and cross-functional coordination to drive issues to resolution in an environment where platform failures carried direct regulatory and compliance risk.
- Designed the TypeScript microservice backend framework and PostgreSQL database schemas Meridian Logistics's platform is built on today, containerizing services with Docker and building GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines to satisfy regulatory auditability and compliance requirements, and wrote the engineering standards and code review processes from scratch as the founding engineer as the team scaled from one engineer to 20+ across backend, DevOps, and QA.
- Introduced tech debt cleanup as a standing part of every sprint, embedding it into the engineering standards and SDLC processes defined from the ground up, keeping a codebase that grew from 1 to 20+ engineers stable across a regulatory-regulated environment where shortcuts carried real compliance risk.

Director of Product Development, Vantage Retail

Dec 2017 – Apr 2019

- Held a dual engineering and product role as an IC at Vantage Retail, defining product requirements with stakeholders and contributing to software architecture decisions alongside establishing the QA standards, CI/CD pipelines, and PR annotation practices that governed how the team designed, reviewed, and shipped code.
- Defined product requirements in collaboration with stakeholders, balancing customer needs, business objectives, and technical constraints.
- Built QA standards and testing protocols for the team, integrating Codecov coverage verification, CI/CD pipelines, and Xray scripts linked to Jira stories, taking test coverage from roughly 50% to 100% as part of the peer review gates.

Software Engineer, Tooling/Automation Lead, Harbor Reviews

Aug 2015 – Dec 2017

- Led automation initiatives and built internal tooling to streamline developer onboarding and integration workflows, cutting onboarding from over 2 weeks to 3 days.
- Built internal tooling and software solutions in JavaScript, React.js, HTML, and CSS within an Agile workflow, contributing to automation initiatives that cut engineer onboarding time from over two weeks to three days.

Senior Software Engineer, Frontend/UX Lead, Nimbus Freight

Aug 2013 – Dec 2014

- Built the frontend media player and user platform in AngularJS, styled with LessCSS and bundled with Grunt, backed by a Node.js/Express API that handled cloud storage interactions for user media collections.
- Migrated the backend from PHP to a Node.js/MEAN stack.

Senior Software Engineer, Beacon Labs

Aug 2012 – Aug 2013

- Managed end-to-end delivery of custom client applications, including accounting and reservation software, by running weekly check-in calls with stakeholders, defining requirements, and tracking work velocity in Pivotal Tracker to keep timelines and delivery goals on target.
- Built custom client applications, including accounting and reservation software, using PHP and AngularJS as the primary technologies throughout the full delivery cycle.

SKILLS

Engineering management, technical leadership, Cross-functional collaboration, Software architecture design, Release management, Software development lifecycle, operational excellence, Incident management, data correctness, Regulatory compliance oversight, Continuous integration and delivery, GraphQL API design, Agile and Scrum methodologies, Sprint planning and backlog refinement, Talent acquisition and development, Team leadership and mentorship, backend engineering, TypeScript